

CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

HOW A GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY COMPANY SCALED ACQUISITION FROM \$0 TO \$12M AT 2.1X ROAS

BUILDING DISCIPLINED PAID AND OUTBOUND DEMAND GENERATION FOR A CYBERSECURITY EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION PORTFOLIO

Organisation	Global technology company with a cybersecurity education and certification portfolio
Period	May 2021 - September 2023
Role / scope	Senior Manager - Performance Marketing Paid, outbound and funnel optimisation
Audience	CMOs, marketing leaders, CEOs and hiring managers

EXECUTIVE OUTCOME

The work managed a documented \$4.79M three-year paid and outbound demand-generation budget and scaled acquisition from \$0 to \$12M at 2.1x ROAS with a sub-18-month payback period. The program connected search, social and programmatic media with landing pages, email, marketing automation and sales follow-up. The customer-success story is commercial discipline: budget ownership was tied to a measurable acquisition system, not simply to media delivery.

METRIC REGISTER AND PUBLICATION STATUS

Each metric is either documented in the supplied profile/project material or marked as an illustrative validation item. Validation items are prompts for recovering the original baseline, denominator, source and attribution; they are not public claims.

Metric	Value	Definition	Status / publication note
Paid/outbound budget	\$4.79M over three years	Aggregate budget managed across paid and outbound demand generation.	Documented in supplied project material.
Acquisition scale	\$0 to \$12M	Growth in acquisition value; define whether value means revenue, bookings or another measure.	Documented outcome; define value and period.
ROAS	2.1x	Return on advertising spend: agreed value divided by advertising spend.	Documented outcome; confirm numerator.
Payback	Under 18 months	Time required for agreed profit or contribution margin to recover acquisition investment.	Documented outcome; confirm definition.

BUSINESS CONTEXT AND CUSTOMER CHALLENGE

The portfolio operated in a category where acquisition efficiency mattered at scale. Cybersecurity education and certification demand can span individuals, enterprise teams, partners and professional communities, each with different motivations and buying cycles.

The challenge was to build a performance system that could absorb a substantial budget without losing control of efficiency. It required media planning, channel management, creative and landing-page testing, lifecycle communication, reporting and commercial interpretation.

STRATEGIC DIAGNOSIS

Acquisition needed to be managed as a portfolio. Search, social and programmatic played different roles, and the right mix could change by audience, product, geography and stage.

Media could not carry the full burden. Landing pages, email, lead qualification and sales follow-up influenced conversion quality and speed. The answer was an integrated funnel.

CAMPAIGN SUCCESS MATRIX

The matrix makes the operating logic visible: business need, strategic move, execution system and success signal. It is deliberately designed for executive readers who want to understand how the work created a repeatable capability, not only a headline result.

Business need	Strategic move	Execution system	Success signal
Scale	increase acquisition without losing control	Portfolio planning and budget governance	\$4.79M managed over three years
Efficiency	improve economics across channels	Audience, bid, creative and landing-page optimisation	2.1x ROAS
Conversion	turn media response into customer action	Search, social and programmatic by job-to-be-done	Acquisition scaled from \$0 to \$12M
Payback	make investment recovery visible	Value tracking and cohort analysis	Sub-18-month payback

APPROACH AND EXECUTION

1. 1. ESTABLISH INVESTMENT GOVERNANCE

The first move was increase acquisition without losing control. Budget decisions considered audience, product, channel role, stage, expected conversion and commercial value. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. Budget decisions considered audience, product, channel role, stage, expected conversion and commercial value. The work was reviewed through the lens of scale, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. \$4.79M managed over three years The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

2. 2. OPTIMISE THE FULL FUNNEL

The first move was improve economics across channels. The program connected media with landing experience, email and automation so the team could fix more than an ad. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. The program connected media with landing experience, email and automation so the team could fix more than an ad. The work was reviewed through the lens of efficiency, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. 2.1x ROAS The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

3. 3. MANAGE CHANNEL ROLES

The first move was turn media response into customer action. Channels were evaluated by the role they played: capture intent, create demand, support consideration or re-engage. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. Channels were evaluated by the role they played: capture intent, create demand, support consideration or re-engage. The work was reviewed through the lens of conversion, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. Acquisition scaled from \$0 to \$12M. The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

4. 4. LINK EFFICIENCY TO PAYBACK

The first move was to make investment recovery visible. ROAS and payback were read together so leadership could see both immediate efficiency and recovery time. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. ROAS and payback were read together so leadership could see both immediate efficiency and recovery time. The work was reviewed through the lens of payback, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. Sub-18-month payback. The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

MEASUREMENT, ATTRIBUTION AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

ROAS requires a defined value numerator and spend denominator. Payback requires an explicit cost and margin basis. The \$4.79M, \$12M, 2.1x and sub-18-month figures are documented, but the final version should confirm currency, dates and definitions.

A senior reader should be able to tell which evidence proves execution, which evidence proves engagement and which evidence proves commercial impact. The case therefore keeps metric definitions close to the story. Where the supplied material documents a practice-level or portfolio-level result, the narrative says so. Where a project-specific number is unavailable, the document names the recovery task instead of manufacturing precision.

BUSINESS IMPACT AND CUSTOMER-SUCCESS INTERPRETATION

The organisation gained a disciplined acquisition engine capable of scaling investment while maintaining return and recovery focus. Marketing could participate in commercial planning with stronger evidence.

The customer-success outcome was confidence. Teams could make budget decisions with a clearer link between campaign activity and business economics, enabling experimentation without losing financial guardrails.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES TO AN EXECUTIVE READER

- Large budgets require portfolio governance, not only platform expertise.
- ROAS and payback answer different executive questions.
- Landing pages, nurture and follow-up are part of paid acquisition performance.
- Definitions protect credibility when historic data is involved.

End of case study